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Introduction to Development Communication

**PAGPADAYON SA NASUGUDAN: CONTINUING THE LEGACY AND FOSTERING
KNOWLEDGE ACROSS GENERATIONS**

That is the theme of our culminating activity held November 23, 2024, on Saturday, a forum about DevCom practitioners in their different fields of work. From preparation until the day of the event, we've shared sweats, laughter, and fatigue, but it doesn't matter since it was successful. During the preparation of the event, we were assigned to respective committees, and I was in the secretariat committee. It was my first choice when they conducted the online documents, but I didn't even know why I chose that one. So, our duties are processing permits, which is very crucial and it was tough; another is collecting waivers; and so on. I learned a lot upon the preparation and processing of permits. From seeking whose personnel this is through finding which offices or buildings they might be located. I have no right to complain because it is our duty and responsibility. Although I memorized the places in the university, I still forget sometimes. It was challenging because I have a really tight schedule and I have to make time for the permits. I'm glad that my partner Edjil was there with me, sharing sweats and almost tears running back and forth from different buildings and offices. I learned about the importance of time management in managing my work, schoolwork, and as a secretariat. I also appreciate the beauty of teamwork and seeking help. It is

okay to ask for help or guidance if you know that you can't do it alone. In addition, was the "there is no harm in trying, and it's better late than never" because it was one day before the event and the permits were submitted to the Director of Instruction office; however, according to assigned staff, one of our documents lacks copies, and the order of documents was not in the correct flow since Edjil was hosting for SciCom day and the other two secretariats were not around. They seemed unbothered by what's going on, so I initiated processing the lacking permit, and when I went to the office where I left the permit for signature, it was already signed. I jumped in happiness because, finally, we can conduct our culminating activity.

During the culminating activity proper, everything was set successfully. I couldn't help it but foresee the success of our event even though we haven't started yet. Two guests arrived first, and I greeted them warmly with a smile. I even let them inside the Coc Office while waiting for our professor, Ma'am Rona. When Ma'am Rona arrived, we all gathered in the MC 1 where the event would take place, and there, the program started.

DURING THE EVENT

"Learn, learn, learn when there are opportunities, it will be a learning experience that one day you will share to the future Development Communicators"

"As DevCom we see we that we might be the solution, but as catalyst of change bisan alagyan lang kita, but it may be an alleviation from poverty, it may be pag resolve sang

problems bisan sa basic unit of community or family, they will have their blessings because of our acts, we did not know, it's gonna be their story to tell. That is our role as Development Communicators, maging way sang hope kag pag bag o bisan sa gamay lang nga butang because Devcom is not just a course program, it is indeed a calling."

"Empathy, you are putting yourself in a situation to understand the problem"

The following quotes are my takeaways from the first speaker, Mr. Chris John D. Billones. I love how he started with a jolly, alive, and enthusiastic energy. I was more amazed when he talked about his journey at the WVSU-COC as a DevCom student. Those quotes really made a big impact on me; upon hearing them, I feel more hopeful, and I feel the spirit of how deserving I am that I'm here in the development communication field. It is indeed true that life is continuous learning, and as for me, I believe that there is more to learn here in DevCom. I always wonder what Devcom is. Way back when I was still an applicant, my aunt, who helped me and supported my studies, introduced this to me when I was a junior high school student, and I thought it was just a new name for Masscom, but now I am enlightened that this is what Devcom is. In the second quote, I really feel indeed that it is a calling. I believe it is my destiny. As someone who belongs to poor families, it has always been my aspiration to uplift our voices, to be heard, and to be acknowledged. Our life status is one of my inspirations to pursue DevCom and to be able to help those families like us in the future. It is the empathy that pushes us to help other people, like, what would we feel if we were in their situation? We are taking considerations and acknowledging their needs. Little do we know, even in the simple and small things, we are already helping them. It's always

the little things first before we can make a big step towards change. He also highlights that not all the time "happy times" because, as college students, we have a lot of responsibilities and to-do lists. I was satisfied when he answered my question in an open forum. I always know how hard it is to accept that you just wanted to be average when you knew the fact that before you were a competitive, top student. I'm glad he was able to help me answer the question that has been my problem since I entered college. Yes, it may not be easy, but I have to accept the fact that it's not about getting a 1.00 GPA all the time because, in the real world, I have to apply the skills and knowledge that I have learned all throughout your college.

"DevCom is not just about journalism and broadcasting, in DevCom you can be in any field, because DevCom is everywhere."

"I face different people with different walks of life, we know their story, we conduct field work, DevCom taught me to deeply understand and to know the root causes because we don't know anything if we don't know their stories so don't treat beneficiaries as beneficiaries, treat them as partners."

On the other hand, the above quotes are my takeaways from the second speaker, Ms. Jaybie Tayapad. Upon entering the COC lobby, I found myself fascinated by her looks; she was elegant in that blue dress. I was more fascinated when she started talking about her DevCom journey. I find really interesting the field in which she is currently working, and it is really aligned to DevCom. I learned from her the importance of understanding people's stories and experiences before attempting to help them because

true empathy and effective solutions come from a deep understanding of the root causes of problems.

"Test the waters and do it scared"

"Ikaw ang ga shape sang kaugalingon mo sa DevCom, of course there are fundamentals but overall ikaw ang ga rebrand and tell the story of Development Communication"

The third speaker, Mr. Bengie Panes, also emphasizes that quote above. Ever since I entered college, my motto changed: if I'm scared of doing something, it is not the basis for me to stop or don't do it, but I'd rather test what I can do and do it with fear. He also taught me and made me realize that here in development communication, I am the one shaping my future as a development communicator. There are principles and foundations, but I am the one molding my skills, knowledge, and perspective within this field. It is how creative or innovative I am in using my experiences here in DevCom in the future path that I will take.

Overall, our event was a successful culmination of learning and growth. It provided valuable insights from experienced DevCom practitioners, inspiring us, the future generations. They highlighted the diverse and impactful roles of DevCom professionals in various fields. Now I understand why, even though it is the last minute of choosing if I will be in the field of science education or development communication, I chose DevCom. It offers many opportunities for careers in the future, and it will help me grow to be the best version of myself. I am looking forward to my journey—to be the voice of

the voiceless and the one who brings valuable changes in the community. I am grateful for this opportunity to learn from experts and connect with like-minded individuals. I am eager to learn more and apply these insights to my own journey as a development communicator in the future.